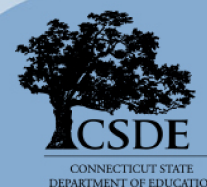


DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21



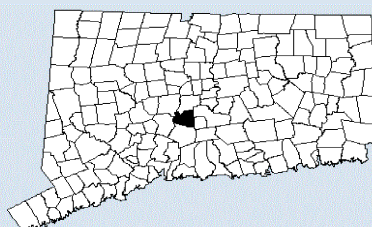
Meriden School District

Dr. Mark Benigni, Superintendent • 203-630-4171 • <http://www.meridenk12.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	30
Enrollment	8,118
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$14,041
Total Expenditures ¹	\$126,001,745

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.



Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

Contents

Students.....	1
Educators.....	2
Instruction and Resources.....	2
Performance and Accountability.....	4
Narratives.....	7

Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.4
Male	4,186	51.6	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	169	2.1	5.2
Black or African American	868	10.7	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	4,727	58.2	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	326	4.0	4.0
White	2,014	24.8	49.9
English Learners	1,313	16.2	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	6,258	77.1	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	1,698	20.9	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	868	21.9	65	1.6
Male	1,000	24.1	143	3.2
Black or African American	209	23.3	32	3.4
Hispanic or Latino of any race	1,250	26.3	113	2.3
White	335	17.0	57	2.7
English Learners	359	26.6	24	1.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,681	26.5	181	2.7
Students with Disabilities	540	32.4	90	4.6
District	1,868	23.0	208	2.4
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 0

Number of school-based arrests: Fewer than 6

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Meriden School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	467.8
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	38.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	94.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	133.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	15.0
School Level	35.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	3.5
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	30.4
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	48.9
School Nurses	14.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	389.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	4	0.6	0.1
Asian	4	0.6	1.3
Black or African American	18	2.6	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	48	6.9	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	1	0.1	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.1
White	622	89.2	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	7.4	7.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	48	65.8	65	84.4
Hispanic or Latino of any race	224	66.3	285	85.8
White	116	75.3	143	88.8
English Learners	41	59.4	80	86.0
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	325	69.0	398	85.8
Students with Disabilities	88	71.5	150	88.8
District	419	69.6	531	87.0
State		75.9		85.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual enrollment courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	99	48.3
Emotional Disturbance	87	41.0
Intellectual Disability	40	41.2
Learning Disability	513	89.1
Other Health Impairment	236	69.8
Other Disabilities	13	20.6
Speech/Language Impairment	129	94.2
District	1,117	68.6
State		67.9

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Meriden School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	223	2.5	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	212	2.4	1.1
Intellectual Disability	98	1.1	0.5
Learning Disability	576	6.6	5.8
Other Health Impairment	341	3.9	3.3
Other Disabilities	119	1.4	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	153	1.7	1.9
All Disabilities	1,722	19.6	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	126	7.3	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	53	3.1	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$83,676,608	\$9,324	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$9,603,657	\$1,183	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$661,908	\$82	\$698
Support services - general administration	\$1,720,015	\$212	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$6,193,300	\$763	\$1,037
Central and other support services	\$4,686,493	\$577	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$12,524,307	\$1,543	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$5,772,505	\$962	\$1,159
Food services	\$219,746	\$27	\$21
Enterprise operations	\$943,207	\$116	\$151
Total	\$126,001,745	\$14,041	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$7,276,434	22.8	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$2,720,484	8.5	11.1
Other Salaries	\$6,855,099	21.5	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$4,647,135	14.6	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$491,872	1.5	5.4
Special Education Tuition	\$7,050,006	22.1	22.5
Supplies	\$149,466	0.5	0.5
Property Services	\$76,011	0.2	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$2,632,094	8.3	7.2
Equipment	.	.	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$1,009	0.0	0.1
Total	\$31,899,610	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		25.3	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	37.9
State	55.8
Federal	4.8
Tuition & Other	1.4

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Meriden School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

READING	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Meriden School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2019-20	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	69	84.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	318	81.8
English Learners	86	77.9
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	463	82.3
Students with Disabilities	152	60.5
District	599	85.0
State		88.8

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2019-20 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Meeting Benchmark on at Least One College Readiness Exam³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	78.9	97	16.9
Male	78.9	75	11.7
Black or African American	80.0	8	5.3
Hispanic or Latino	74.6	51	7.6
White	85.1	87	27.6
English Learners	69.1	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	75.8	95	10.2
Students with Disabilities	62.0	*	*
District	78.9	172	14.2
State	85.0		36.0

³College readiness exams and benchmark scores are as follows:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

Copyright © 2021 The College Board. www.collegeboard.org

ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2021 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

Copyright © International Baccalaureate Organization 2021

* The data are suppressed to ensure confidentiality.

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2020	Class of 2019
	Entrance ³	Persistence ⁴
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	58.0	74.8
Male	42.9	72.3
Black or African American	50.8	68.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	42.1	66.4
White	58.2	80.8
English Learners	29.7	54.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	43.6	66.5
Students with Disabilities	22.2	*
District	50.3	73.7
State	67.4	84.9

³ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁴ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Meriden School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	23.0%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	26.1%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	78.4%	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	14.2%	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		91.3%	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		85.0%	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		80.6%	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		50.2%	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		64.4%	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	80.6%	13.4%	9.8%	Y

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Meriden School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The Meriden Public Schools (MPS) has eight elementary schools, three middle schools, and two high schools. More than 77% of the district's student population of 8,500 students are eligible for free or reduced-priced meals, and 75% are students of color. Implementation of our District Improvement Plan has led to promoting student-centered learning environments across the district using blended learning, leading to greater choice and voice, critical thinking, creativity, and academic gains. Restorative practices at secondary schools have increased student voice and improved school climate. Elementary schools are also engaged in implementing restorative practices. In our 1:1 environment, students are provided district-issued devices to use with digital content in classes and to explore anytime, anywhere, learning beyond the classroom, thus preparing students for the global world in which we live. Students keep their devices over the summer to access digital resources. High school students can enroll in online courses during the summer as well. Students may "check out" mobile hotspots if in need of Internet access.

MPS is committed to a school improvement process that uses a formal data-based examination to drive the development of curriculum, assessments, and the professional learning process with the single focus of improving student learning. School improvement plans include assessments conducted regularly throughout the school year. School-based data teams analyze data to identify areas where improvement is needed and areas where significant progress has been made. Plans are supported by our MTSS plan to strengthen Tier 1 and provide Tiers 2 and 3 interventions. While School Improvement Plans are specific to school needs, they are aligned to the District Improvement Plan's goals in Talent, Academics, Climate, and Operations.

With the adoption of Connecticut's Common Core Standards, the district has embedded these standards into the district's English Language Arts-Literacy and Mathematics curriculum and implemented the NGSSS in Science and the Connecticut Elementary and Secondary Social Studies Frameworks. The district has implemented the new state requirement of 25 credits to graduate. The District Improvement Plan was recently revised by the District Leadership Team which meets monthly to review district academic, attendance, discipline, and school climate data. MPS has developed a Climate Suite of tools in collaboration with Dr. Larson, Office of Research and Evaluation, and input from teachers and students. The Team monitors progress provides feedback and makes recommendations to our central office team.

Efforts to engage our families include our Family School Liaison Team, which works to connect families to school supports, educates families on school and district expectations, makes home visits, and fosters school-community events. Community and Parent Learning Walks, led by teachers at the high schools, also allow the community and parents to see learning in action. The district recently implemented ParentSquare district-wide. ParentSquare enables users to select from 100 languages to receive messages, allows teachers to use it for class-group messaging and one-to-one communication, and allows permission slips, automatic attendance, and more. MPS has a 99.1% contact ability across the district.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

The Meriden Public Schools believes that education is the great equalizer and provides a path to a better life for all students. The district continues to be proactive in combating systemic racism in our schools. We embrace the richness of our diversity, value our tapestry of different colors and cultures, and remain committed to addressing racial discrimination or unconscious bias. Meriden ensures all students have access to quality educational experiences and graduate college, career and life ready. Our long-standing commitment to equity is evident in initiatives implemented during the last decade. We have eliminated tracking, ensured courses were rigorous and college level, implemented a "no zero" grading policy to support students, transitioned from traditional to student-centered learning classes, reallocated resources to provide 1:1 environments with district-issued Chromebooks to level the playing field, offer free mobile hotspots for families lacking internet access, allow students to keep their Chromebooks over the summer to access online learning, opened access to all courses, including honors, Advanced Placement and Early College Experience, and encourage middle school students to take selected high school courses, initiated restorative practices and youth dialogues developed a cadre of Equity Leaders, generated a series of Racial Equity Awareness training modules, created an Affinity Group for educators of color and other interested teachers, and continue to seek additional avenues to continue and expand our equity work across the district. Most importantly, the district has recently hired a Director of Equity and Instruction to ensure equitable opportunities and access for all learners.

Our steps include a six-pronged approach: 1). Equity Leaders are continuing to roll out racial equity awareness training modules to high school teachers in small group settings to encourage conversations about the material presented; 2). Equity Leaders are expanding racial equity awareness training to middle and high school teachers using the same protocols; 3) Equity Leaders are presenting components of racial equity awareness training modules at our Board of Education meetings, Administrators' Meetings, Elementary

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Meriden School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The Meriden Board of Education takes great care to equitably allocate resources among the district's schools and programs based on the needs of individual buildings and district initiatives and apply an equity lens to allocations. Resources for such areas as ongoing supplies and compensation for the errors inherent in enrollment projections are maintained. The Office of Teaching and Innovation maintains an emergency account that ensures all schools have necessary materials in cases where the building budget is unable to meet needs. The size of the building determines resource allocations for custodial supplies and manpower, and the age and condition of buildings are used to determine the priority list for major improvements and repairs